Amathuba Group Assignment Runbook

From Group Setup to Mark Release

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October 2026

1 Purpose

This guide explains how to:

- record students in project groups;
- close student group selection before work begins;
- allow one member to submit for the group;
- capture one shared mark for the submission; and
- check and release the results.

The aim is simple: make submission easier for students and remove repeated mark capture for the teaching team.

This runbook covers an assessment where group members receive the same mark, except for approved individual adjustments. It follows official Amathuba and Brightspace guidance, with additional checks recommended for our workflow.

2 Before You Start

Agree the following with the course convener:

- the assignment name and marking rubric;
- the maximum group size;
- how students will be assigned to groups;
- the group-selection deadline;
- submission and marking deadlines;
- the maximum mark and assessment weighting;
- how individual exceptions will be approved; and
- who may publish the results.

Permissions. An authorised course owner, lecturer or administrator must manage group setup. The standard tutor role cannot create, manage or delete groups under the permissions described in the CILT Groups guide [1].

If the required controls are unavailable, ask the course owner to complete the setup or contact CILT.

3 Step 1: Create the Project Groups

1. Open the correct course site.
2. Go to **Course Info > Groups**, or locate **Groups** through Course Admin if the navigation differs.
3. Select **New Category**.
4. Use a clear category name, for example: *FTX1005F Investment Project 2026*.
5. Choose the enrolment approach:

Approach	When to use it
Manual	The teaching team assigns students to agreed teams.
Automatic	The course wants the platform to allocate students.
Self-enrolment	Students choose their own project team.

For student-selected teams, choose a self-enrolment option that specifies both the group count and capacity, where available. Enter the required values and save [4].

For planning, 150 students in groups of five would require approximately 30 groups. Confirm the actual class size and course policy before creating them.

Check: The category is specific to this project and the groups have the intended capacity.

4 Step 2: Confirm and Fix Membership

Set a self-enrolment expiry date before the assignment begins. Do not enable random allocation of unassigned students unless the convener wants that behaviour [4].

Before the deadline:

1. Tell students which category to join.
2. Ask them to check that all teammates have joined the same group.
3. Give them a contact route for problems.

After the deadline:

1. Reconcile the groups against the class list.
2. Resolve missing students and incorrect teams.
3. Check group sizes.

4. Retain a dated membership record.
5. Confirm, using an authorised student test account, that self-service joining or leaving is no longer available.

Closing student selection does not prevent authorised staff from correcting membership. Later changes should be approved, recorded and followed by a check of the affected results.

5 Step 3: Create the Grade Item

Open **Grades**.

If the gradebook has not been configured, use the **Setup Wizard** with the course convener. Select the grading system and calculation rules that match the approved course assessment structure [3].

Do not change an existing gradebook's calculation system simply to add this assignment.

Under **Manage Grades**:

1. Create the project's grade item.
2. Give it a recognisable name.
3. Set its maximum points.
4. Place it in the correct grade category, if the course uses categories.
5. Set the approved weight where applicable.
6. Check when students can see the item.

A maximum mark of 100 and a course weighting of 20% are different settings. Use the actual values approved for the course.

Create one grade item for this assessment, rather than one grade item for every project group.

6 Step 4: Create and Link the Assignment

Go to **Activities > Assignments > New Assignment**.

1. Enter the assignment name and instructions.
2. Set the submission deadline and availability.
3. Under **Submission & Completion**, select **Group Assignment**.
4. Select the project group category.
5. Choose the submission format, normally **File submission**.
6. Set the permitted files and submission rules.

Under **Grade Out Of**, enter the maximum mark. Use **In Grade Book > Edit or Link to Existing** to select the grade item created in Step 3.

Under **Evaluation & Feedback**, attach the approved rubric if one is used [2].

Important: Filtering an individual assignment by group does not make it a group assignment. Confirm the actual assignment type.

Configure this before students submit. The CILT Groups guide states that the assignment cannot switch between individual and group submission once submissions have been received [1].

7 Step 5: Test the Complete Workflow

Use an authorised sandbox and fictional test records.

1. Create two test groups with different members.
2. Submit a test file for each group.
3. Give Group A a test result of 61/100.
4. Give Group B a test result of 78/100.
5. Test publication in the sandbox.
6. Check that every A member receives 61 and every B member receives 78 in the intended grade item.
7. Check that feedback reaches the correct group.
8. Confirm the student view.

Also test an approved individual adjustment if the course expects to use one.

Record what happened and resolve failures before opening the live assignment. Do not use a live assessment grade item for fictional test marks.

8 Step 6: Explain Submission to Students

Publish a short notice with the actual dates and course contact details.

> Good evening everyone,
>
> Please check that you have joined the correct investment project group on Amathuba before the group-selection deadline.
>
> One member should submit the final assignment on behalf of the group. Please agree who will submit and check that the correct final file has been uploaded.
>
> Group selection closes before the assignment begins. If your membership needs correcting afterwards, contact the teaching team.
>
> The shared project mark will apply to the recorded group members, subject to the course's rules on individual adjustments.
>
> Kind regards,
> Tshidiso

Replace general references to deadlines with the actual dates before posting.

9 Step 7: Mark Each Group Submission

9.1 Open the Submission

1. Go to **Activities > Assignments**.
2. Open the project assignment.
3. Find the allocated group's submission.
4. Check its group identity and membership.
5. Open the submitted file.

Agree marker allocations beforehand so two markers do not unintentionally evaluate the same submission.

9.2 Evaluate the Work

Apply the same approved rubric and moderation process used for the assessment.

1. Read the group's work.
2. Assess each criterion.
3. Record the shared result in the evaluation panel.
4. Add useful feedback.
5. Attach a feedback file or use annotations where appropriate.

For example, if a five-person group earns 72/100, capture **72 once against its group submission**. The configured group assessment distributes the shared result to the recorded members [1].

Do not enter 72 separately against each student as the normal workflow.

9.3 Save Drafts During Marking

Use **Save Draft** while the evaluation is still being checked. Publish only when authorised.

Draft evaluations should not be treated as completed gradebook entries. Brightspace distinguishes draft feedback from published feedback when synchronising with the gradebook [5].

10 Step 8: Check Results Before Release

Before publication, confirm:

- every expected group submission is accounted for;
- membership matches the approved teams;
- marks use the correct scale and rubric;
- the assignment links to the intended grade item;

- individual exceptions are approved;
- missing submissions are handled under course policy;
- feedback is attached to the correct group; and
- grade visibility matches the release plan.

Use the sandbox test to establish how group results reach individual records. Keep the live grade item and assignment feedback visibility under the convener's control during verification.

A missing result is not automatically a zero. Investigate it before applying the course policy.

11 Step 9: Publish and Verify

After approval:

1. Publish the completed evaluations using the assignment's publication controls.
2. Open **Grades**.
3. Verify the linked results for the expected group members.
4. Check approved individual adjustments.
5. Confirm that students can see the intended mark and feedback.

A linked assignment sends the published result to the gradebook through the supported evaluation workflow [5]. The gradebook's visibility settings still need to match the course release plan.

If a mismatch is found, stop further publication, retain the records and agree the correction with the convener.

12 Step 10: Handle Exceptions Carefully

12.1 Individual Adjustments

Where course policy permits a different result for one member:

1. obtain the required approval;
2. retain the original shared mark;
3. record the individual adjustment and reason;
4. apply it through the supported Grades workflow; and
5. verify that only the intended student is affected.

Brightspace supports individual gradebook overrides for group assignments [6]. Test the local workflow before using it.

Recheck an individual override after updating the shared group evaluation. Do not assume it will remain unchanged.

12.2 Membership Corrections

Do not move students between groups after marking without checking the consequences for their results.

Confirm the correct team with the convener, record the change, and inspect both affected groups' membership and grades.

13 Common Problems

Problem	What to do
Cannot create groups	Check the course role. Ask an authorised owner or administrator to complete setup.
Student cannot join	Check the selected category, capacity and sign-up window. Refer late changes to the teaching team.
Student has no mark	Check membership, grade linkage and publication. Correct only after confirming the intended result.
Members have different marks	Check for an approved adjustment, incorrect membership or an earlier manual entry.
Gradebook is empty	Check that the assignment is linked and its evaluation has been published. A draft is not proof of a synchronised result.
Wrong submission type	Check before submissions open. If submissions already exist, consult the convener and CILT before changing the workflow.
A group needs remarking	Update its shared evaluation, complete moderation and recheck members and individual exceptions.

14 Discussions and Quizzes

Groups can also organise other course activities. However, this runbook's shared-mark procedure applies to a **group assignment**.

Do not assume that restricting a discussion or quiz to a group makes one student's mark apply to everyone. Those tools need their own assessment configuration and verification.

For this project, use the group-assignment workflow unless the convener approves a different assessment design.

15 Handover

Give the next teaching team:

- this runbook;
- the assignment and group category names;
- the grade item and assessment settings;
- marker allocations and the rubric;

- the membership record;
- approved exceptions and test results; and
- the mark-release and correction records.

Keep student records in authorised institutional storage. Check group membership, dates and grade links again when copying the process to another course or semester.

16 References and Training Resources

The official guides below support the setup and marking steps. The tests, reconciliation and handover checks are practical recommendations for this workflow.

The CILT staff hub also links its comprehensive getting-started guide, tutor guide and official Amathuba video collection. Use those links to locate current training on Groups, Grades and Assignments.

The exact video titles listed in the original AI-generated answer were not all independently verified, so they are not presented here as separate confirmed publications.

References

[1] University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching. *Groups*. Updated 17 September 2026. Especially pp. 4–8 and 17–18. https://cilt.uct.ac.za/sites/default/files/media/documents/ched_uct_ac_za/1429/Groups.pdf

[2] University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching. *Assignments*. Updated 20 March 2026. Especially pp. 5–9. https://cilt.uct.ac.za/sites/default/files/media/documents/ched_uct_ac_za/1429/Assignments.pdf

[3] University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching. *Grades*. Updated 1 September 2026. https://cilt.uct.ac.za/sites/default/files/media/documents/ched_uct_ac_za/1429/Grades.pdf

[4] D2L. *Create and manage categories and groups*. Brightspace documentation. https://community.d2l.com/brightspace/kb/articles/4944-create-and-manage-categories-and-groups

[5] D2L. *Evaluate assignments using the Assignments tool*. Brightspace documentation. https://community.d2l.com/brightspace/kb/articles/3529-evaluate-assignments-using-the-assignments-tool

[6] D2L. *Group Assignments in Advanced Assessments*. Supplementary reference for individual gradebook overrides; this runbook does not require enabling Advanced Assessments. https://community.d2l.com/brightspace/kb/articles/33538-group-assignments-in-advanced-assessments

[7] University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching. *Amathuba Resources for Staff*. Includes links to the comprehensive getting-started guide, tutor guide, tool guides and training. https://cilt.uct.ac.za/support-and-services-amathuba/amathuba-resources-staff

[8] University of Cape Town, Centre for Innovation in Learning and Teaching. *Amathuba — UCT's New Learning Management System*. Official video collection linked from the staff hub. https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLqSYUJvxD-UAoUeEHo5n65KrcW0lxy5-V